S4 Reader Summary and Clinical Boundary

Why this healthy-participant exploratory study is not clinical evidence

Article type: Supplement

Short title: S4 Scope ds004511

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Scope

This study contains no patient cohort, clinical outcome, intervention, diagnostic test, or individual prediction. Participants contributed ordinary laboratory EEG during Rest, cognitive control, and a gambling task. The mathematical summaries are research estimators, not validated biomarkers.

Plain-language finding

Different summaries of the same recording answer different questions. A local chart-Jacobian quantity was higher for GG than Rest, but a separately identified one-step quantity did not show the same pattern. Among recordings where a one-step map could be estimated, two rotation summaries were lower. This is a warning against collapsing measures, not a biological explanation of behaviour.

What readers should not conclude

Do not infer diagnosis, treatment response, deception detection, consciousness, causal brain control, or a clinical measurement scale. Replication on a locked pipeline, predeclared analysis plan, and relevant patient or longitudinal datasets would be required before clinical translation.

Bibliography